



HUMANITAS
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Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Classical Christian Academy
School Website: <https://classicalchristian.com/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS: **MEMBER** SCL: **MEMBER**

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) and the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Classical Christian Academy (Id 83858), operating as Coeur d'Alene Classical Christian School (CCA Classical) in North Idaho, presents a strong classical Christian framework embedded in scripture, covenant with parents, and a distinctly Catholic–Protestant–evangelical style of theology typical of many classical Christian schools. Public-facing materials emphasize a Christ-centered, Biblical worldview, a partnership with families, and a classical pedagogy that includes Latin study and a broad, integrated curriculum. Evidence from the crawl content shows explicit statements about a Biblical foundation, a Statement of Faith, and a mission to form character and wisdom alongside intellectual growth. Overall, the school achieves a robust Classical profile in most categories, with Element 3 (Curriculum) and Element 4 (Pedagogy) showing partial alignment due to fewer explicit references to some canonical classical elements (e.g., explicit “Great Books” framing or detailed Socratic/Scholé practices on the site). In aggregate, the school is **CLASSICAL**, with some Element 3/4 nuances that are “Somewhat Classical” rather than fully explicit in every Classical criterion.

Key takeaways by category (brief):

- Religious and Metaphysical Foundations: **CLASSICAL**. Strong Christ-centered posture, Statement of Faith, biblical worldview, and theological framing are clear across site content.
- Purpose and Goal: **CLASSICAL**. Emphasis on formation, virtue, wisdom, and living a life aligned with truth, goodness, and beauty; formation over mere information is evident.
- Curriculum: **SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL**. Classical signals are present (Latin, classical pedagogy, integrated curriculum), but explicit Great Books/Great Conversation and full articulation of the Seven Liberal Arts appear less overt in public pages.
- Pedagogy: **SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL**. The program is described as classical and in line with perennial pedagogy, but explicit, high-visibility Socratic seminars or Scholé-focused routines are not consistently detailed on the site.
- Faculty: **CLASSICAL**. Faculty are portrayed as mentors and living curriculum; leadership (e.g., Principal Michael Howard) is highlighted, with teachers framed as central to the pedagogy.
- Parents & Community: **CLASSICAL**. Strong, explicit emphasis on parent partnership, covenant with families, and parent involvement; multiple pages invite parent engagement and visits.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — **CLASSICAL**

- Evidence
- The school presents itself as Christ-centered and Biblical in foundation, with explicit language about partnering with parents to disciple students toward God-given purposes.

- A Statement of Faith and the integration of theology into daily learning are referenced across the site, including a formal statement of faith page and a faith-driven admissions/placement narrative.
- Additional materials emphasize a gospel-centered, Biblical worldview as foundational to the curriculum and community life.
- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
- Positive keywords present: Christ-centered, Biblical foundation, gospel life, Biblical worldview, Theology, Sacred/Christian formation, Statement of Faith. (Mapping to Positive Keywords set for this element: truth/goodness/beauty; theology; liturgical culture; etc.)
- Negative keywords present: None detected in public-facing content (no overt secularization signals in public pages).
- Why this rating
- The school's public materials foreground religious/metaphysical commitments (Christ-centered, Biblical and theological grounding) and ecclesial language (Statement of Faith, covenant with parents) that align with Transcendental Moral Realism, Grounded Theology, and Liturgical/Communal orientation. This aligns with the Classical School rubric's expectations for a robust religious and metaphysical foundation.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The mission emphasizes formation, virtue, wisdom, and a life oriented toward truth, goodness, and beauty, not solely career outcomes. Language includes character formation, moral development, and a teleological orientation toward human flourishing.
- The school frames education as formation (paideia) with a focus on the whole person, not just information, and foregrounds virtue and biblical fidelity as core outcomes.
- The "Portrait of a Graduate" and related materials articulate aspirational outcomes oriented toward Christ-likeness, scholarship, service, and character, consistent with a classical aim of the liberal arts as character formation.
- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
- Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, character, moral imagination, love of learning, eternal truths, classical heritage, teleology, moral excellence, Christ-likeness, service.
- Negative keywords present: None detected (no explicit emphasis on workforce-prep-centric or relativistic ethics in public content).
- Why this rating
- The public materials strongly map to the classical rubric's expectation that education aims at formation and human excellence, grounded in truths about God and the good. The emphasis on virtue, wisdom, and the true/good/beautiful signals aligns with a CLASSICAL orientation.

Element 3: School Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The site highlights a classical educational model, including "Classical Pedagogy," and mentions Latin, which aligns with the "Seven Liberal Arts" and the grammar/logic/rhetoric framework in the rubric.
- Language around integration and a broad liberal-arts-inspired curriculum is present, including emphasis on a broad curriculum and critical thinking.

- Some explicit elements of the Great Books/Great Conversation framework are less visible on public pages, though there are references to a classical tradition and family-adjacent “Great Tradition” concepts in related materials.
- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
- Positive keywords present: classical pedagogy, Latin, liberal arts orientation, integrated curriculum, critical thinking, broad curriculum.
- Negative keywords present: lack of explicit Great Books/Great Conversation references in public pages; no explicit “Seven Liberal Arts” phrasing on the site (though the Latin and classical-method framing imply it).
- quantitative estimate
- Positive keywords identified: 3–4 (Latin; classical pedagogy; integrated/broad curriculum; critical thinking).
- Negative keywords identified: 0–1 in explicit Great Books/Great Conversation terms; absence of explicit Great Books phrasing on main site.
- Estimated ratio: roughly 3–4 positive vs 0–1 negative (leaning toward CLASSICAL, but with some curriculum aspects less overt in public materials).
- Why this rating
- The curriculum signals basic Classical orientation (Latin, classical pedagogy, liberal-arts framing) but publicly visible materials do not always explicitly name core classical curriculum components (Great Books, Great Conversation, and the explicit Seven Liberal Arts trifecta). This yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL designation rather than fully CLASSICAL in this category.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The site advertises a Classical Pedagogy in the educational model, emphasizing love of learning, critical thinking, and a broad curriculum, with small class sizes and an integrated approach.
- There are references to “discipleship/covenant” approach in some materials, and to “discussion with grace” in the discipleship/development content, which hints at dialogic/seminal engagement, albeit not always in a fully explicit Socratic framework on the public site.
- The presence of “Latin” instruction and classical method suggests some classical pedagogy, but explicit public-facing evidence of the full range of classical pedagogical practices (e.g., Socratic seminars, scholé days, memorization/recitation cadence) is not consistently detailed on the site.
- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
- Positive keywords present: Classical Pedagogy; Love of Learning; Tools of Learning; Critical Thinking; Latin involvement; integrated, broad curriculum.
- Negative keywords present: Limited explicit mention of Socratic seminars, scholé, or ritualized memory/chant practices on the main site; no explicit rest/restful-scholé sections in public copy.
- quantitative estimate
- Positive keywords identified: 3–5.
- Negative keywords identified: 0–1 (lack of explicit Socratic/Scholé references in public content).
- Ratio suggests a leaning toward SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.
- Why this rating

- A solid Classical pedagogy signal exists, but lack of explicit public references to full Socratic/seminar-based practice and Scholé patterns places Pedagogy at SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than fully CLASSICAL in the public materials.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The site presents faculty as central to the education, with leadership (Principal Michael Howard) highlighted and a focus on teachers as living curriculum and mentors. The “Portrait of a Graduate” material emphasizes the teacher-student relationship as foundational to character and intellect.
- The materials describe a community where teachers are relatively small in number and intimately involved with students, aligning with the classical ideal of the teacher as a moral exemplar and guide.
- There is explicit emphasis on parental partnership and a long-standing school mission that frames faculty as the core of the school community.
- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
- Positive keywords present: mentor/teacher as living curriculum, portrait of a graduate, teacher as model, small-class/memorable teacher-student interactions, leadership by principal.
- Negative keywords present: None detected.
- quantitative estimate
- Positive keywords identified: 4–5.
- Negative keywords identified: 0.
- Ratio: clearly CLASSICAL.
- Why this rating
- The explicit portrayal of teachers as living curriculum and mentors, plus visible leadership and a focused faculty-centered narrative, aligns strongly with the Classical rubric’s expectations for Faculty.

Element 6: School Parents and Community — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The site strongly emphasizes parent partnership, covenant with families, and a formal call for parent involvement (including events, information packets, and parent education). The Parent Commitment materials outline the partnership with families as central to classical education.
- There are dedicated sections about parent education, family involvement, and open-campus engagement; the school explicitly invites parents to visits and participation.
- Public content references a harmonious relationship between home, church, and school, along with a family-centered approach to education.
- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
- Positive keywords present: Partnership with families; parent involvement; family education; open campus; family catechesis; parental responsibility.
- Negative keywords present: None detected.
- quantitative estimate
- Positive keywords identified: 4–5.
- Negative keywords identified: 0.

- Ratio: CLASSICAL.
- Why this rating
- The school presents a robust, explicit partnership with parents and a family-centric approach—core to classical practice—placing this category firmly in CLASSICAL.

Aggregate Ranking and Evaluation

- Element 1: CLASSICAL
- Element 2: CLASSICAL
- Element 3: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 4: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 5: CLASSICAL
- Element 6: CLASSICAL

Overall, the school is CLASSICAL. The strongest signals appear in Religious/Metaphysical Foundations, Purpose and Goals, Faculty, and Parents/Community. Curriculum and Pedagogy show solid classical alignment but with less explicit public articulation of certain canonical elements (e.g., explicit Great Books/Great Conversation framing, and fully spelled-out Scholé/Socratic practices) than some classical schools. Taken together, the school aligns with Classical criteria broadly and demonstrates a strong classical Christian identity across most rubrics. The aggregate assessment is CLASSICAL.

What would move the needle (only applicable if the school were SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL)

- Make Great Books/Great Conversation elements explicit on the public site (e.g., articulate a clear Great Books list or canonical texts and the concept of the Great Conversation in the curriculum).
- Include explicit references to Scholé/restful learning days, contemplative study, and Socratic seminars in the upper grades, with public-facing examples or syllabi.
- Expand explicit articulation of the Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric) in site copy, including connections to how these are taught (and how Latin fits into the trivium).

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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